

With the Rockstor Snapshots feature, you have the ability to create automatic point-in-time backups of your work, irrespective of the nature of the work (whether documents, videos, music, code, presentation, etc), and also build a strategy to manage backups.

Setting up the Rockstor storage platform for Snapshots and other tasks

To start using Snapshots and other features, you need to set up pools, shares, Samba export, etc. So follow these easy steps and you will be ready to use Rockstor's features. Once the Rockstor platform is installed, you can set up, configure and use it from a browser.

After the initial set-up, the next step is to create storage for your data. During installation on VirtualBox, you must have created virtual hard disks or added disks, if you are using bare metal. Now, we will go a step further and create pools and shares. A pool is essentially a collection of disks with a user defined redundancy (RAID) strategy. The size of a pool can be increased or decreased by adding or removing disks. Available RAID options are RAID 0, RAID 1, RAID 5, RAID 6 and RAID 10. And a share is essentially a chunk of storage space carved out of a pool. A share can also be thought of as a directory.

Disks

On the Rockstor Web UI, under the 'Storage' tab, you will see the disks. Figure 2 shows the disks that are available on my Rockstor box. Notice that disk 'sda3' has the system created 'rockstor_rockstor' pool containing the OS. It's recommended that this pool be left alone for the OS and not be used except for maybe small shares, if absolutely necessary. Resizing, compression or deletion of this pool is not permitted.

Pool

To create a pool using the Web UI, go to *Storage->Pools*. Click on 'Create Pools' and specify the 'Name', 'Raid Configuration' and 'Select Disks' that should be the part of this pool. Click 'Submit' to create the pool. Advanced users can also apply different compression and BTRFS mount options while creating a pool (or afterwards). One huge advantage that Rockstor offers here is the ability to resize a pool by easily adding or removing disks. Figure 3 shows how a pool can be created. You can see the pool 'data_backup' in Figure 2.

Share

Once a pool is set up, you can create a 'share' from your pool. To create a share, go to *Storage->Shares* and click 'Create Share'. Specify the 'Name', 'Pool' and 'Size', and click 'Submit'. Similar to a pool, advanced users can apply compression options.

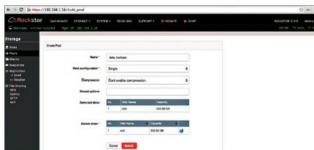


Figure 3: Pool



Figure 4: Shares



Figure 5: Create a Samba export

Internally, shares are BTRFS sub-volumes of a given filesystem (pool). A share can be exported from the Rockstor system with NFS, Samba, AFP and SFTP protocols. There is no upper limit, except available storage, on creating shares. A share can be cloned, resized and deleted from the Web UI. For this example, I have created a share called 'Marketing_Proposals' as shown in Figure 4.

To export a share using Samba, go to the Web UI, and click *File Sharing -> Samba*. Click 'Add Samba Export' and select parameters such as 'Shares to export', as well as permissions like 'Browsable', 'Read only', etc. For the 'Admin Users' field, choose the username for your Rockstor account. For example, if the account name is 'admin', select that from the drop down list. If it is your own name, choose that from the drop down list. Refer to Figure 5 for the details of my form.

Samba export of the share

Windows users can click the 'Enable Shadow Copy' option. For more details on 'Shadow Copy', follow the